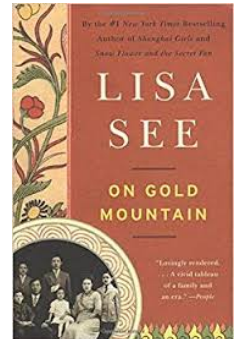


## Angel Island Introduction

After watching the [video about Fong See's immigration experience](#) (9:29), please answer the following questions:

1. Why did Fong See immigrate to the United States? (Think push/pull factors)
2. What are some of the hardships faced by Fong See? (Name at least 3 hardships)



Next, read the article [Voices from Angel Island](#) (also on the back) and answer the questions related to the primary sources. Be sure to read the introduction on the left-hand side:

1. Why did these three immigrants come to the United States?

|           |  |
|-----------|--|
| Mr. Wong  |  |
| Mrs. Chan |  |
| Mr. Leung |  |

2. Based on these excerpts, what was most traumatic for each immigrant?

|           |  |
|-----------|--|
| Mr. Wong  |  |
| Mrs. Chan |  |
| Mr. Leung |  |

3. What were “paper sons and daughters”?
4. What do these immigrants have in common with Fong See?

## Voices from Angel Island

Primary Source: Interviews with Chinese Immigrants

*As Ellis Island was the place of entry for European immigrants arriving in New York, Angel Island in San Francisco Bay was the first stop for Asians who wanted to make the United States their home. Between 1910 and 1940 more than 170,000 Chinese came to Angel Island. For most, the dingy and unsanitary wooden barracks there must have seemed very different from the Gam Saan—"Gold Mountain"—they had hoped to find in America.*

*Before the exclusion laws were repealed in 1943, some Chinese were able to enter the country as members of the exempt classes. Others were offspring of immigrants who had come to the United States as merchants, but many more had to lie about their heritage to gain admission. These "paper sons" bought identification cards and secret coaching papers in Canton, China, then spent months memorizing the details of their new identities, knowing that they would face difficult interrogations from U.S. immigration officials. In these excerpts, three Chinese immigrants remember their experiences on Angel Island.*

### Mr. Wong (immigrated in 1933, aged 12):

They told me that anyone who comes to Gam Saan will make money fast and go home a rich man. Anyone who comes to America is well respected in China. My family pushed me to come. They wanted me to make a better living. They couldn't send my older brother because he was too old to match the age of my uncle's paper son. I studied (coaching papers) for a whole summer at school. It included many, many generations. I had to remember everyone's name, the birthday, and if they passed away, when. And you had to know the different points of the village, what it looked like. I remember I had an English cap that we picked up in Hong Kong and inside the cap, my father hid some coaching notes, so that once in awhile, I could refresh my memory. But I never had a chance to look at them, because you're among people all the time and you don't trust anyone. There was no private place where I could be alone to study them. One time, they were playing catch with my cap and they didn't understand why I was so upset. I was scared.

### Mrs. Chan (immigrated in 1939, aged 23):

I was forced to come to America. I had never seen my husband before. My mother matched me in marriage so that I could bring the family over later. I had a passport to come when I was 16, but I didn't come until I was 23 when the Japanese attacked. Most of us then came as daughters of citizens or wives of businessmen. Other wives weren't allowed to come. I came as a granddaughter of a citizen. The papers had been purchased for me.

### Mr. Leung (immigrated in 1936, aged 24):

When it was my turn to be interrogated . . . they called me in and started asking me this and that, this and that, until I had a headache. . . . The next day, they questioned me again. . . .

One strange question they asked me was: "What is your living room floor made of?" I replied, "Brick." They said, "Okay. What is the floor under your bed made of?" So I thought if the living room floor was brick, then the bedroom must also be brick. So I said, "Brick!" . . . The next day, they asked the same question and I replied, "Brick" again. They said my father had said it was dirt. What happened was that the floor was dirt at first, but later, after my father left for America, I changed the floor myself to brick.

Where I really went wrong was in answering the question about who gave me the passage money. My father had written that he would send the money home to my mother to give me so that's what I said. But what happened was my father didn't really have the money and another relative loaned the money to my mother. So although I was a real son, I failed the interrogation.

My deepest impression of Angel Island now was the rudeness of the white interrogators. They kept saying, "Come on, answer, answer." They kept rushing me to answer until I couldn't remember the answers anymore. And it wasn't just the whites. The Chinese interpreters did too.